MONTHLY UPDATE

Regional collaboration: monthly update, September – October 2026

Edition of 2026-10-12 · compiled by Claude Opus from the documents in the Corpus repository

> *38 places. Every block below is carried verbatim from that place's own monthly update, where it was written, sourced and checked; nothing is written here.*

ALGERIA · ANGOLA · BENIN · BURKINA FASO · CAMEROON · CHAD · COMOROS · CONGO · COTE D'IVOIRE · DJIBOUTI · DR CONGO · EGYPT · ESWATINI · ETHIOPIA · GABON · GHANA · GUINEA · KENYA · LESOTHO · LIBERIA · LIBYA · MADAGASCAR · MALAWI · MALI · MAURITIUS · MOROCCO · MOZAMBIQUE · NAMIBIA · NIGER · NIGERIA · RWANDA · SOMALIA · SOUTH AFRICA · SOUTH SUDAN · TOGO · TUNISIA · UGANDA · ZIMBABWE

The place reports do not share one window; the period above is the range they span.

Algeria

With Niger, the two prime ministers reaffirmed three trans-Saharan projects, among them the fibre-optic backbone, at talks in Algiers on 27 August, and on 8 September Algérie Télécom's Skills Centers network signed a convention with Niger's telecommunications and post college on infrastructure capacity and training. No value, duration or trainee target is published for the convention. The Algerian and Nigerien ministers launched operation of the fibre link between In Guezzam and Arlit-Agadez at a starting capacity of 100 Gbps.

Angola

Angola is one of 49 states that signed, with the European Space Agency, a declaration that Earth- and Universe-observation satellite data should be accessible to all under open licences, save justified exceptions, published on 10 September.

Benin

At a joint assessment of the Seme-Krake border post on 11 September 2026, Nigeria's customs offered Benin real-time exchange of declarations, manifests, transit data, risk profiles and enforcement alerts. The two administrations share the post and no system. The Beninese and Togolese data-protection authorities held a joint working session at Lome on 2 and 3 October on sharing experience and building skills, after the Togolese authority's mission to Cotonou in August. The agreement's own date and text are not held.

Burkina Faso

The telecoms regulators of Burkina Faso, Mali and Niger announced on 23 September a cooperation convention for signature on 25 September, creating a standing Sahel regulators' council to coordinate roaming within the confederation, spectrum, cybersecurity, consumer protection and mutual recognition of type-approved equipment.

Cameroon

The region began drafting the rules for moving data across its own borders, in this country's second city. Experts from Central African member states met in Douala from 31 August to 4 September to assess national readiness and agree the pillars of a regional framework on cross-border data governance, with technical and financial support from the German development agency, a continental development agency, the Economic Commission for Africa and the African Union Commission. Pillars are all that is agreed: no draft text, adoption route or timetable is published.

Chad

The digital ministers of Chad and Nigeria held talks in N'Djamena on 16 September 2026 on fibre connectivity and artificial intelligence. No agreement is on record.

Comoros

Bahrain's e-government authority held its first knowledge-exchange session with the Comorian digital agency, on the governance and approval of government technology projects.

Congo

A seminar with the DRC closed with a Brazzaville Declaration urging digitalised migration and customs procedures along the 2,400km border; it binds neither government.

Cote d'Ivoire

Abidjan hosted the final African preparatory meeting for the ITU Plenipotentiary Conference, which closed on 17 September 2026 with 46 African Common Proposals. Space and spectrum regulation were the most debated issues; the next stage is an inter-regional meeting in Saudi Arabia on 13-14 October.

Djibouti

In September the Digital Cooperation Organization's secretary-general and the digital-economy minister discussed cooperation on artificial intelligence, digital skills and capacity building; no memorandum, programme or budget is stated, and the repository holds no accession date for Djibouti's membership.

DR Congo

The country is one of 49 states that signed, with the European Space Agency, a declaration that Earth- and Universe-observation satellite data should be accessible to all under open licences, save justified exceptions, published on 10 September.

Egypt

The communications ministry took part in the second Arab artificial-intelligence summit at Hammamet from 7 to 10 September, organised by the Arab ICT organisation with the League of Arab States, working towards unified Arab positions on artificial-intelligence governance, digital sovereignty and data protection. No instrument, declaration text or work programme from it is held.

Eswatini

A second regional channel opened alongside the SADC one. The Digital Cooperation Organization's secretary-general met the ICT minister on cooperation to accelerate digital transformation, the country presenting 1.76m mobile connections against a population of about 1.3m and 95% fourth-generation coverage. These are exploratory talks with no memorandum, work programme or membership step recorded, and the connection and coverage figures are the government's own. The communications commission and Lesotho's regulator signed a memorandum providing for cybersecurity cooperation, including coordinated incident response, and exchange of information and resources.

Ethiopia

The regional transit corridor moved from agreement to build. On 7 September the three national operators presented the corridor to Google, Meta, Microsoft and Amazon, alongside carriers and equipment vendors, at a pre-commercialisation meeting in Addis Ababa, seeking partner and customer interest before commercial launch. No route length, capacity, cost, in-service date or transit-revenue projection is published.

Gabon

Two outward moves in the same week, one to learn and one to be heard. An interior, security and decentralisation ministry delegation spent nearly two weeks in Rwanda on digital transformation and e-governance, artificial intelligence and digital policy, civil-registration and identification digitisation, cybersecurity, data protection, interconnection of public systems and decentralised service digitisation - the longest and widest-ranging of eight delegations the host received that week. Separately the digital economy minister presented the country's candidacy for the International Telecommunication Union Council in Nassau on 3 September, under the slogan Shaping the Digital Future. Neither carries an agreement, an adoption decision or a campaign platform beyond the slogan.

On 23 September the foreign minister signed the United Nations Convention against Cybercrime on the margins of the General Assembly, which the government presents as a framework for mutual legal assistance and the exchange of electronic evidence. It is a signature; no ratification instrument is on file.

Ghana

Ghana's regional position moved on three fronts, none of them with a text attached. The communications minister was unanimously confirmed as the next chair of the African Union's Specialised Technical Committee on Communication and ICT, for two years from October 2026, the same statement naming participation in the Africa Network of Cybersecurity Authorities, an Arab Region roundtable and work with the Council of Europe's Cybercrime Convention Committee.

Guinea

The Guinean and Nigerien audiovisual regulators committed in a joint communique in Conakry on 26 September 2026 to press digital platforms for protocols on algorithm transparency and to promote media and digital literacy, under a 2026-2028 roadmap. A government delegation was among eight hosted by Rwanda's cooperation agency at the end of August to study its e-government institutions.

Kenya

The continental data convention still has no Kenyan signature behind it. A high-level parliamentary dialogue on accession was called for 7 September 2026. What has moved is the process, not the treaty position, and no instrument of accession is on the record.

On 21 September the ICT cabinet secretary proposed that willing African Union states jointly test one cross-border public service and report by February 2027, citing eCitizen and the interoperability framework. No state is on record as joining.

The ICT cabinet secretary signed the Digital Cooperation Organization's Charter in New York during the UN General Assembly, reported on 28 September, making Kenya a Signatory Member and one of eight approved candidates whose accession would take membership from 16 to 24 countries. Neither the signing date nor the date accession completes is given.

Lesotho

The border is to be digitised from both sides: the Bi-National Commission's mid-term review agreed to accelerate smart one-stop border posts at Maseru and Ficksburg, with no design or date published. The communications authority and Eswatini's regulator signed a memorandum providing for cybersecurity cooperation, including coordinated incident response, and exchange of information and resources.

Liberia

The revenue authority signed a memorandum, announced on 20 September, to help its Gambian counterpart build a revenue collection dashboard on the model of its own, sending its dashboard's developer to Banjul for an initial three weeks. No value is stated.

Libya

UNDP, a Gulf telecoms group and a Doha institute convened a digital and AI policy leaders forum for the Arab states region in Doha, reported on 2 September, to move a regional digital policy framework to country-level action.

Madagascar

On 10 September Madagascar was one of 49 states, with the European Space Agency, to sign an international declaration on space-based scientific data, committing to open access to satellite observation data save justified exceptions, open licences and harmonised exchange standards. It names no implementing measure.

Malawi

Officials of Malawi and Japan discussed stronger digital and innovation ties, reported on 1 September. No agreement is on record.

Mali

The Burkinabè, Malian and Nigerien telecommunications regulators signed a cooperation convention creating a Council of Sahel Regulators, reported on 26 September, covering free roaming, frequency coordination at the borders, mutual recognition of type-approved equipment and coordinated 5G introduction; its statutes and first work programme are still to be adopted. They had announced the signing on 23 September.

The communication ministry convened digital and media actors on 2 September to weigh a common confederation framework for regulating social media, with a reference text developed in Burkina Faso put forward as the model. The West African body's page for its regional fibre infrastructure programme is held as at September 2026. The country withdrew from the body in January 2025, and nothing on the page says what that leaves of its participation.

Mauritius

Mauritius is one of 49 states that signed, with the European Space Agency, a declaration that Earth- and Universe-observation satellite data should be accessible to all under open licences, save justified exceptions, published on 10 September.

Morocco

The UN Economic and Social Commission for Western Asia and the minister for digital transition signed a memorandum in Rabat establishing a framework for regional cooperation on modernising public administration and advancing digital governance reform. No programme, value or deliverable is attached to it.

Mozambique

The ICT institute joined TriDigital, reported 9 October 2026: a common framework and bilingual platform for assessing the digital maturity of public institutions in Angola, Guinea-Bissau, Mozambique and São Tomé and Príncipe, running to January 2028 and including a demonstration diagnostic of the country's own maturity.

Namibia

An assessment of national law against the continental Protocol on Digital Trade went to a validation workshop at Windhoek, reported on 5 October, to feed a National Digital Trade Action Plan. No findings or dates are published.

Niger

The confederation's communication regulators opened a constitutive conference in Niamey on 17 September for a joint platform, framed around informational sovereignty and a common strategy against disinformation, with artificially generated content among the stated concerns. No charter, secretariat or powers have been published.

The Burkinabè, Malian and Nigerien telecommunications regulators announced on 23 September that they would sign a cooperation convention in Ouagadougou on 25 September creating a Council of Sahel Regulators, covering confederation roaming, cybersecurity, frequency management and mutual recognition of type-approved equipment.

Nigeria

The customs service and HM Revenue and Customs met in Abuja on 25-26 September 2026 to finalise a mutual administrative assistance agreement on customs information sharing; signing is hoped for in December. Nigeria's and Benin's customs piloted the interconnection of their systems at Seme-Krake from 11 September. A Lagos workshop on 16-17 September set out the terms of issue of the ECOWAS biometric identity card, and ministers of Chad and Nigeria held talks on fibre connectivity and AI in N'Djamena on 16 September.

Rwanda

One piece of regional machinery moved from design into use. The delegation also completed a two-week learning mission to India on digital public infrastructure, concluded 7 September, alongside four other countries and African Union representatives.

The country was selected on 21 September to host the seventh UN World Data Forum, expected in the fourth quarter of 2028, the second African host after Cape Town in 2017. Rwanda was one of 49 states to sign a declaration that Earth- and Universe-observation satellite data be open to all under open licences, and its head of state warned at the first International Space Summit that African countries risk losing access to orbital and radio-frequency resources.

Somalia

A 15-member delegation's ten-day mission to Pakistan closed with a roundtable in Islamabad on 16 September 2026 that set three working groups on identity, data exchange and financial inclusion, with an action matrix of 30-, 60- and 90-day steps.

South Africa

On 31 August the higher education minister told a meeting of regional vice-chancellors in Johannesburg that the region must build its own computing capability, trusted datasets, African-language technologies and cybersecurity rather than rent intelligence from others. One of the minister's five immediate priorities is agreement on a regional higher education data system. By the ministers' meeting in June 2027, the minister said, the region should be able to point to students and academics who have moved and to data being shared. The meeting's closing message was the same: build the systems that let qualifications, research and skills cross borders. No design, host, funding or data scope has been set for the data system.

South Sudan

South Sudan and Uganda signed a memorandum in Juba for real-time epidemiological data sharing, mutual outbreak notification and joint surveillance at the border, with no platform named.

The revenue authority signed a third customs memorandum with Uganda's, the first to cover digital interoperability and enforcement of Uganda's electronic permit system, on the corridor that carries most of the country's imports. No systems link or timetable is published.

Togo

On 23 September the data-protection authority signed a cooperation agreement with its Malian counterpart covering information exchange, complaints handling, compliance checks and staff capacity-building, with cross-border data transfers among the subjects discussed. The agreement text is not published. The data-protection authority hosted its Beninese counterpart at Lome on 2 and 3 October 2026 under their cooperation agreement.

Tunisia

The health ministry presented a Tunis Declaration on digital health at an international telehealth conference in Tunis, committing to health-data protection under national law, cybersecurity and interoperable systems on open standards; no signatory list or full text is held. Tunisia hosted the African Telecommunications Union's spectrum management conference on 7 September and, from 8 September, four days of African preparatory talks for the 2027 World Radiocommunication Conference.

Uganda

Uganda and South Sudan signed a memorandum in Juba on 7 September for real-time epidemiological data sharing, mutual outbreak notification, joint surveillance and harmonised screening at border crossings. No data platform, legal safeguard or budget is named.

The revenue authority signed a third customs memorandum with South Sudan's, the first to cover digital interoperability and enforcement of Uganda's electronic permit system.

Zimbabwe

On 21 September POTRAZ, which holds the second vice-presidency of the Network of African Data Protection Authorities, marked the first Africa Data Protection Day with a call for privacy-by-design; the network has 34 member authorities.

ABOUT THIS DOCUMENT

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